

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A potential breakthrough** in the Iran-U.S. war lifted stocks, clinching a third straight week of gains for major indexes. For the week, the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq rose 3.2%, 4.5% and 6.8%, respectively. West Texas Intermediate oil tumbled 11% to \$83.85 a barrel. **B10**

◆ **The San Diego Padres** are nearing a \$3.9 billion deal to be sold to private-equity billionaire José E. Feliciano and his wife Kwanza Jones, according to people familiar with the matter. **A1**

◆ **Drone maker Aevox** went public in an IPO that valued the key player in Ukraine's fight against Russian invaders at more than \$2 billion. **B9**

◆ **Ford is recalling** up to 1.39 million F-150 pickups over the risk of unexpected downshifting that can lead to a loss of vehicle control. **B9**

◆ **American Airlines** has rejected United CEO Scott Kirby's proposal that the two carriers merge. **B9**

◆ **Ericsson expects** network growth despite reporting a sales drop in North America in the first quarter and warning that the cost of components is rising. **B9**

◆ **State Street reported** higher first-quarter profit, boosted by fee growth, particularly for its foreign exchange trading services. **B10**

Worldwide

◆ **A top Iranian official** raised hopes of a breakthrough in the standoff between Washington and Tehran when he said the Strait of Hormuz is “completely open,” while President Trump said a U.S. naval blockade on Iranian ports would remain in force, stirring uncertainty among shippers in the region. **A1, A6-7**

◆ **The Justice Department** is preparing to file an anti-trust lawsuit against some of the country's biggest egg producers over allegations they coordinated pricing, people familiar with the matter said. **A3**

◆ **Trump's feud** with Pope Leo XIV and the president's AI-generated image of himself as a Christ-like figure are testing the loyalties of the roughly 53 million U.S. Roman Catholics. **A4**

◆ **A national-security** surveillance program was extended until April 30 after a proposal to renew it for five years failed to advance in Congress. **A4**

◆ **Rep. Ilhan Omar** (D, Minn.) said she isn't as wealthy as documents she previously submitted to Congress suggest because there were major accounting errors in her filing. **A5**

◆ **North Korea is advancing** its ability to expand its nuclear arsenal, upping activity at its main nuclear facility, including work on a suspected new enrichment site. **A7**

PEGGY NOONAN

Trump meets his match in Pope Leo. **A13**

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Children gesture from a vehicle Friday near Tyre, Lebanon, as displaced people make their way back to their homes after a 10-day cease-fire between Lebanon and Israel took effect.

Abel Puts Stamp on Berkshire In 100 Days

By KRISTAL HUR

On an afternoon in December, as Greg Abel was days away from taking the reins of Berkshire Hathaway, he took questions from employees at a weekly staff luncheon.

One asked if he was going to move the company out of Omaha, its headquarters for decades. No, Abel said, there would be no move.

The idea would have seemed absurd at nearly any point during Warren Buffett's run as Berkshire's leader. But what many of the employees were surely thinking is that change is coming.

Abel has elevated deputies who worked closely with him as head of the conglomerate side of Berkshire, taken a bigger annual salary than Buffett while pledging to spend most of it buying company shares, and revived a stock buyback program that had idled since 2024. He has also doubled down on Berkshire's interests in Japan, buying a stake in an insurer there.

Known for being more hands-on than Buffett, Abel is scrutinizing Berkshire's businesses and stock portfolio with a fresh, and more critical, eye than his predecessor, people familiar with the mat-

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Altman's Investments Raise Conflict Concerns at OpenAI

By BERBER JIN AND KATE CLARK

When Sam Altman was briefly fired, then rehired as OpenAI CEO in 2023, the company's board of directors had fretted over what little they knew about his personal investments and whether they posed potential conflicts.

A newly formed board pledged to fix the problem, but it never went away. As OpenAI, the maker of Chat-

GPT, hurtles toward a planned initial public offering this year, valued at around \$850 billion, the question persists—how to determine whether decisions serve the company's best interest or Altman's.

He recently asked OpenAI to lead a funding round for Helion after the nuclear-fusion startup fell behind on promises of a breakthrough energy source and began to run short on cash. Altman is one of He-

lion's largest investors, and a sizable chunk of his net worth is tied up in the company.

Altman also sought OpenAI backing for Stoke Space, a rocket-maker aiming to challenge Elon Musk's SpaceX. Altman is a shareholder through Hydrazine, his venture-capital-firm-turned-family-office, according to people familiar with the matter.

Neither investment currently represents a core busi-

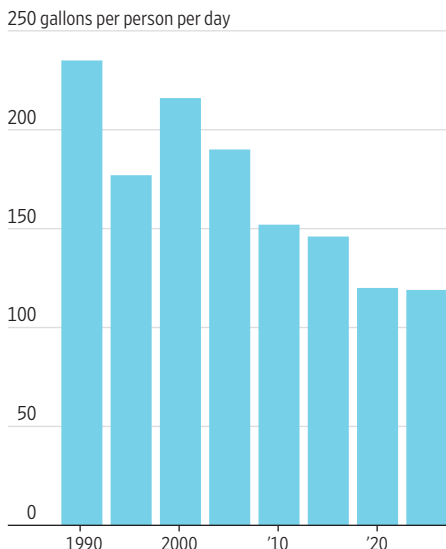
ness for OpenAI, which recently told employees the company needs to cut back on side projects and focus on addressing growing competitive pressure.

OpenAI's lead in the AI race is slipping after spending years as Silicon Valley's darling startup. Altman, who holds no direct equity in the company, has unloaded many of his managerial responsibilities. Some initiatives he previ-

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Parched States Find Lifeline

Per capita water use in the San Diego region



Source: San Diego County Water Authority

Drought-plagued states are turning to San Diego for water in a dramatic turnaround. After the California city suffered a five-year drought that ended in 1992, the county water authority invested billions to achieve water independence. As supplies grew, residents cut water use by nearly 50% over the past quarter-century, turning San Diego into a water exporter. **A5.**

Padres Near Sale Deal For Record \$3.9 Billion

By JARED DIAMOND AND MIRIAM GOTTFRIED

The San Diego Padres are nearing a deal to be sold to private-equity billionaire José E. Feliciano and his wife Kwanza Jones, according to people familiar with the matter.

The deal values the Padres at around \$3.9 billion—the highest valuation ever achieved by a Major League Baseball team, the people said. The previous record was Steve Cohen's \$2.4 billion purchase of the New York Mets in 2020.

The deal for the Padres, which have been owned by the Seidler family since 2012, is expected to be announced early

next week, the people said. Jones and Feliciano, a co-founder and managing partner of Clearlake Capital, beat out a group of bidders that included Golden State Warriors owner Joe Lacob and businessman Dan Friedkin. Several bids were more than \$3.5 billion, some of the people said.

Born in Puerto Rico, Feliciano has a net worth of around \$3.9 billion, according to Forbes. He worked at Goldman Sachs before starting Clearlake in 2006 with fellow managing partner Behdad Eghbali. While most of the firm's investments have been in traditional technology, industrial

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People Who Listen to Podcasts Are Suddenly Feeling Left Out

Industry's embrace of video means if you're not watching, you're lost; 'Who? What?'

By DAVID MARCELIS

Jordan Blair was behind the wheel when she realized she had picked the wrong podcast to listen to.

"Today, we're touching down in the '70s to talk about Chippen- dales. Not these guys. Theeseese guys, whose name comes strangely from...this guy,"



Joy's canceling

Harvey Guillén, the host of "Killer Stories," said in the episode's intro.

"Who? What?" Blair recalled thinking. Then she remembered: "Killer Stories" had begun offering a video version.

"When I realized that there was not going to be any context given, I was a little an-

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In Florida, Billionaires Open Their Own Schools

By DEBORAH ACOSTA

PALM BEACH, Fla.—Not long after real-estate developer Jeff Greene moved from California to this exclusive Florida enclave, he noticed something sorely lacking: private school openings for all the wealthy families streaming in.

So, the billionaire set out to create his own pre-K to 12th grade campus. At the private Greene School in West Palm Beach, students have two teachers per class and continue with school activities until they are summoned to

line up for dismissal in a precision-timed digital queue.

The property feels more like a tech campus than a stuffy private school, with classes in 3-D printing and another with flight simulators. One group of students is building a small airplane from scratch, which they said will be certified by the Federal Aviation Administration. In other ways, the campus resembles a summer camp with a tennis academy and sailboats.

The children of South Florida's new tech titans and

EXCHANGE



CAMP MYSTIC

The Texas camp is still a crime scene—and preparing for 850 campers this summer. **B1**